FDA Food Labeling Policy Update

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Agenda

- FDA’s Role in Nutrition
- Dietary Guidelines for Americans
- FDA’s 2026 Food Priorities



FDA's Role in Nutrition

FDA's goal: Ensure people in the U.S. have greater access to healthier foods and nutrition information to identify healthier choices quickly and easily

- **Empower consumers** with information to identify healthier food choices
- Help create a **healthier food supply**



Dietary Guidelines For Americans

USDA



realfood.gov

2025–2030

FDA’s Human Foods Program 2026 Priorities



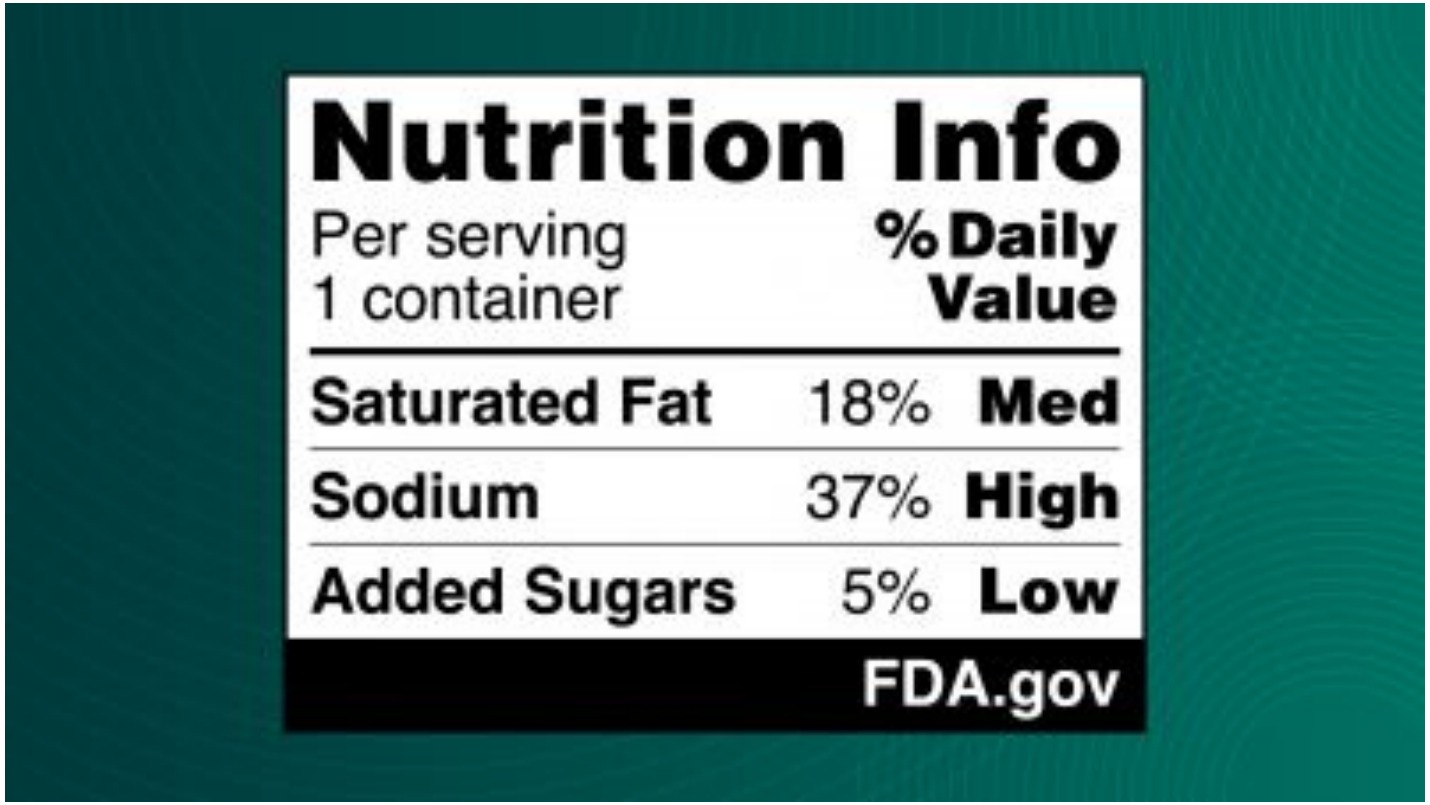
https://www.fda.gov/about-fda/human-foods-program/human-foods-program-2026-priority-deliverables#Deliverables

Ultra-Processed Foods

- Growing body of research links UPFs to a range of negative health outcomes
- Addressing UPF is a key element of MAHA agenda
- FDA and USDA working to develop a **uniform UPF definition**



Front-of-Package Nutrition Labeling



Allergen Labeling

- February 18-20, 2026: Virtual Public Meeting and Listening Session on **Food Allergen Thresholds** and Their Potential Applications

  https://www.fda.gov/food/workshops-meetings-webinars-food-and-dietary-supplements/virtual-public-meeting-and-listening-session-food-allergen-thresholds-and-their-potential#event-information

- January 21, 2026: Labeling and Preventing Cross-Contact of **Gluten** for Packaged Foods Request for Information

Standards of Identity

- Conducting ongoing analysis of FDA's portfolio of over 250 Standards of Identity (SOI)
- Announced in July 2025, FDA revoking or proposing to revoke 52 standards
- Proposed to update over 60-year-old SOI for pasteurized orange juice in August 2025



Additional Nutrition Priorities

- Guidelines for caffeine labeling
- Added sugars reduction strategy
- “Healthy” claim implementation
- Sodium reduction

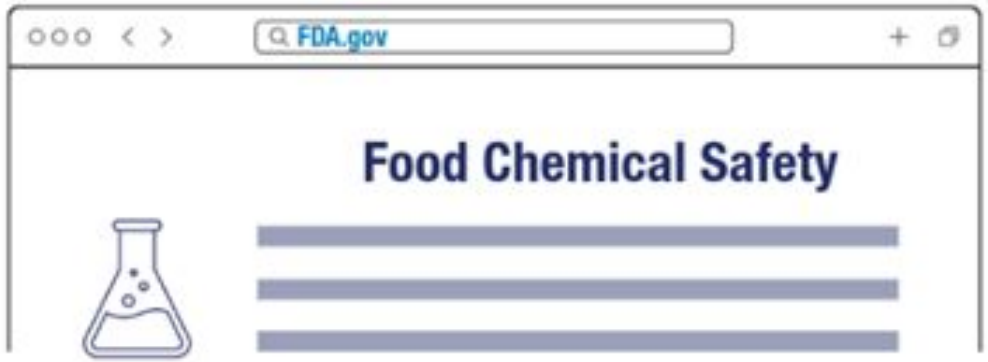


Food Chemical Safety

- Eliminating petroleum-based food colors from the food supply:
  - Initiated process to **revoke authorization** of 2 petroleum-based dyes
  - Approved new **colors from natural sources**
  - Launched a **public tracker** of industry commitments
  - Providing enforcement discretion for **“no artificial colors” claims**
- Developed a proposed rule to **close the GRAS loophole**

FDA finalizes the Food Chemical Safety Post-Market Assessment Program, launches reassessment of BHT and ADA

- FDA formally launches a science-based post-market assessment program for chemicals in the U.S. food supply
- Re-evaluating safety of butylated hydroxytoluene (BHT) and azodicarbonamide (ADA)



Butylated Hydroxytoluene

Used to prevent spoilage of fats and oils in food products.

Azodicarbonamide

Used in flour and bread making and in the manufacture of food contact materials.




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